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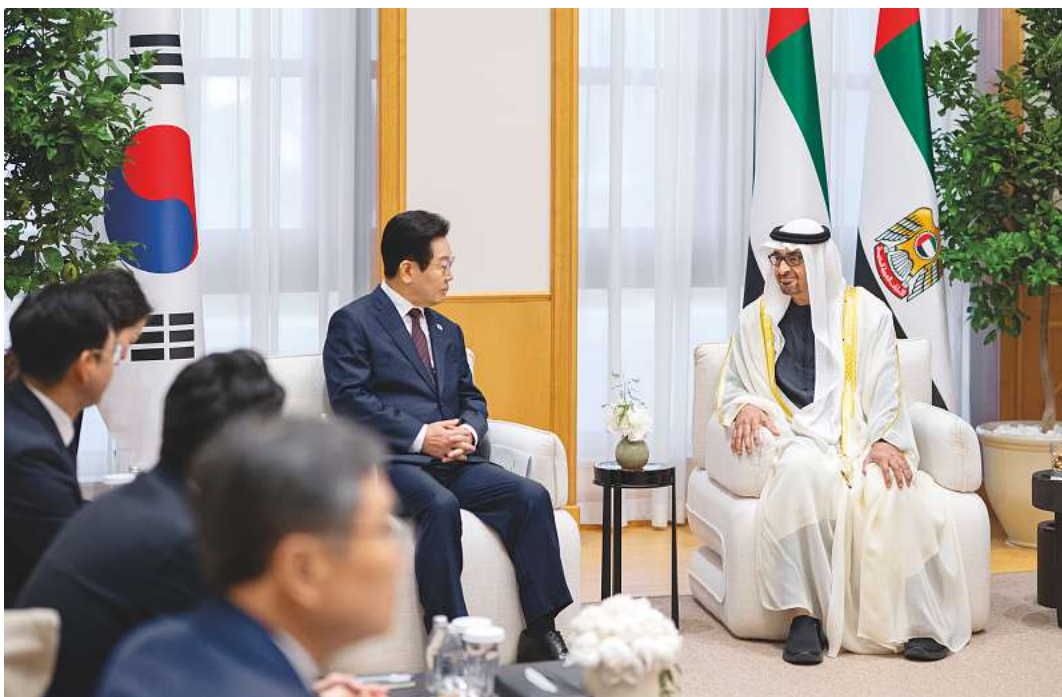
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UAE Presidential Court

MOHAMED MEETS WITH SOUTH KOREAN PRESIDENT

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan during his meeting with Lee Jae Myung, President of South Korea, at Qasr Al Watan yesterday. The leaders later witnessed the exchange of several memoranda of understanding and agreements aimed at strengthening the Special Strategic Partnership between the countries.

No minimum salary for personal loans in UAE

LOWER-INCOME RESIDENTS GAIN FORMAL CREDIT ACCESS

DUBAI
BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

A major change in the UAE's lending landscape is set to reshape who can access personal credit, giving banks full discretion over eligibility while keeping household risk in check through strict macro-prudential rules.

The UAE has removed the Dh5,000 minimum salary requirement that shaped personal-loan approvals for years. Banks confirmed they received instructions to drop the salary floor, a shift that opens the door for residents who were traditionally shut out of formal borrowing.

You're now seeing a lending environment where banks set their own thresholds based on internal risk models instead of following a single national benchmark. This affects workers earning below Dh5,000, students, youth, and those without formal salary slips.

Once salaries move through WPS-linked accounts, instalments can be deducted automatically.

Monica Malik, Chief Economist at Abu Dhabi Commercial Bank, said: "Such a move would increase financial inclusion and place the onus on individual banks to make the lending decisions."

New flexibility

The change moves the system away from a fixed salary rule and toward bank-driven risk assessment. You get wider access to formal credit, and lenders take a more central role in evaluating income consistency, repayment ability, and overall borrower behaviour.

Malik continued: "The continued limits on personal loans — such as on loan size, repayment caps etc — will continue to limit leverage risks for house-

holds. The macro-prudential framework remains strong."

This underlines how the regulatory guardrails stay intact. Banks may widen access, but they must operate within caps on loan size, tenure, and repayment burdens. The framework keeps household risk from creeping upward even as eligibility expands. Repayments will increasingly run through the Wage Protection System. Once salaries move through WPS-linked accounts, instalments can be deducted automatically. You get more predictable recoveries, and banks gain cleaner data on income trends.

Low-wage workers benefit

A large share of UAE workers earn below Dh5,000. Many relied on informal lenders, cash advances, or unregulated credit. Removing the salary barrier pulls this entire segment into the supervised banking system and lets them build repayment records that qualify them later for auto loans, home finance, or larger credit lines.

Airshow sparks major UAE investments

UK commits to future of Dubai's new airport alongside Emirates

DUBAI
BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

Dubai Airshow 2025's second day brought a series of high-impact developments, underscoring how quickly the UAE's aviation sector is scaling up. Etihad Airways made one of the day's biggest moves by committing to 32 additional Airbus aircraft, expanding both its passenger and cargo capabilities.

The Abu Dhabi carrier has

also adjusted its long-term plans, raising its 2030 fleet target to 200 jets and lifting its projected passenger capacity to 37 million.

flydubai buys 150 aircraft

flydubai also stepped into the spotlight with its first-ever order from Airbus — 150 A321neo aircraft. The agreement marks a major shift for the airline, which has until now relied solely on Boeing.

Another major development came from the ongoing transformation of Al Maktoum International Airport. The \$35 billion expansion programme secured its first overseas financing after UK Export Finance (UKEF) issued a \$3.5 billion Expression

of Interest. The commitment highlights growing international confidence in Dubai's plan to build an airport capable of handling 150 million passengers by the early 2030s, with long-term capacity set to exceed 260 million.

UK Trade Minister Sir Chris Bryant formally handed over UKEF's commitment, noting the potential for UK companies to contribute advanced airport systems, sustainable technologies, and integrated mobility solutions.

Emirates is also scaling its investment at the airport, allocating an additional \$10–\$12 billion for its own operational facilities.

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MIDDLE EAST

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THE COLLECTIVE

PARTY EDIT 2025

WISHLIST NO°2

25th November 2025

Taj Jlt, Dubai | 10am - 8pm

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